

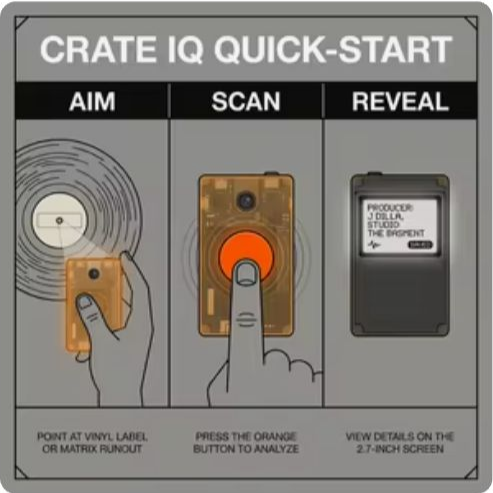
CRATE IQ: Quick-Start Guide for First-Time Diggers

The CRATE IQ is designed to be a "disappearing" tool—powerful in its intelligence but minimal in its interaction. This guide walks you through the 3-step process to reveal the soul of any record.

1. The Visual Guide

The following infographic illustrates the core "Aim, Scan, Reveal" workflow. It follows the "Less, but Better" design philosophy to ensure you spend more time with the records and less time with the device. [TulamixsDesignwanted](#)

Representative instructional guide:



2. Step-by-Step Onboarding

Step 1: AIM

- **The Action:** Point the CRATE IQ's rear pinhole camera at any high-information area of the record.
- **Target Areas:** The center label (for catalog numbers and tracklists), the back-cover credits, or the matrix run-out (for mastering facts).
- **Distance:** Maintain a distance of roughly 10–15cm (4–6 inches) for the autofocus module to lock on. [Reddit](#).

Step 2: SCAN

- **The Action:** Press and hold the **Orange Tactile Button** on the side of the device.
- **Tactile Feedback:** You will feel a subtle mechanical "click" and a faint haptic vibration once the device has captured the frame. [Mi](#).
- **Processing:** The device uses its local, offline database to match the visual data. No internet connection is required—all intelligence is on-device for total digging privacy.

Step 3: REVEAL

- **The Action:** Review the metadata on the high-contrast Sharp Memory LCD. [Digikey](#).
- **Navigation:** Use the side-dial (on Pebble/Precision models) or the mechanical toggle to scroll through deep credits.
 - **Personnel:** Musicians, vocalists, and engineers.
 - **Sample Lineage:** Who sampled this track, and what does it sample?
 - **Label Facts:** Pressing variations, studio locations, and release year.

3. Pro Tips for the Crate

Scenario	Digging Tip
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Low Light Crates	The CRATE IQ's AR1335 sensor is optimized for low-light. If it's too dark to see, the device will provide a haptic "pulse" to indicate it needs more light. E-Consystems .
Damaged Labels	If a label is torn, scan the Matrix Run-out (the numbers etched into the vinyl near the label). This is the most accurate source of pressing intelligence.
Small Print Credits	Use the "Macro" mode by moving closer (up to 30mm). The autofocus module is specifically spec'd for fine-print archival. E-Consystems Reddit .

4. Maintenance & Care

- **Cleaning:** Wipe the translucent amber housing with a dry micro-fiber cloth. Avoid harsh chemicals that could cloud the polycarbonate.
- **Storage:** Keep in your pocket or record bag. The aluminum/polycarbonate unibody is designed to withstand the rigors of warehouse digging. [Cncrapid](#).
- **Charging:** Use any standard USB-C cable. A full charge provides approximately 12 hours of active scanning.

Next Steps for the Community

To deepen your CRATE IQ experience, you can:

1. **Database Updates:** Sync with your local music library via USB-C to personalize your "Sample Lineage" alerts.
2. **Custom Keymaps:** Reconfigure the scroll dial for "Year-First" or "Personnel-First" viewing.
3. **Community Firmware:** Explore open-source UI skins that match your specific design aesthetic (e.g., "90s Dark Mode").